

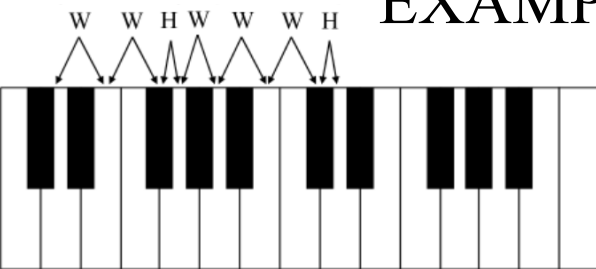
MUSIC 101

Lesson 1: The Major Scale

A scale is a set of notes that sound specially harmonious together. In order to find the MAJOR scale for any note, you'll start at the base note and count using the following pattern of whole steps and half steps

W-step W-step H-step W-step W-step W-step H-step

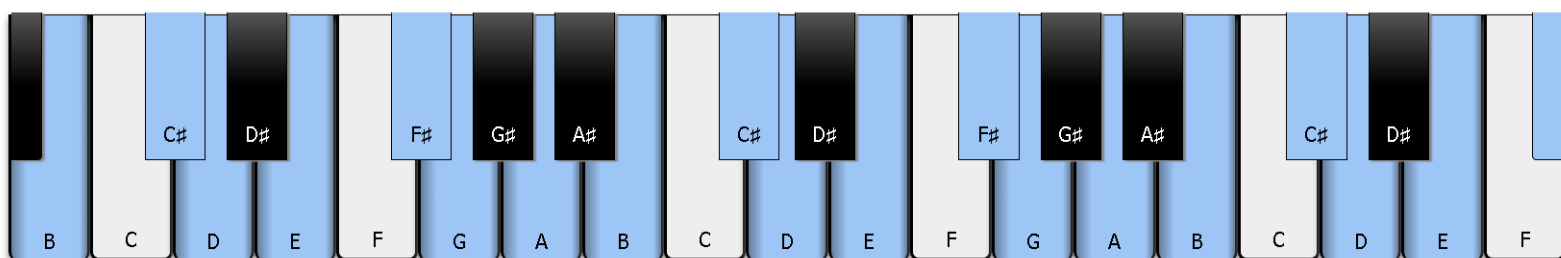
EXAMPLE



In this particular example, the Key is D MAJOR

We start at D, then the second note of the scale is a wholestep above D which is E, then another whole step and we get F#, then a half step and we get G. Continuing the pattern, the D Major scale has the Notes

D E F# G A B C# D and so on....
W-step W-step H-step W-step W-step W-step H-step



The notes of a scale

Notes in the major scale play different roles, and they are named accordingly, I will use the D Major scale as an example

- 1- The Tonic) The "Home" note that you always return to in order to resolve an idea, in the D Major Scale, this is D
- 2- The Supertonic) The second note of a major scale. In the D Major scale this is E
- 3- The Mediant) The third note of a major scale. In D Major, this note is F#
- 4- Subdominant) The fourth note, used to build up tension, it resolves nicely to the tonic. In D Major, this is G
- 5- Dominant) The fifth Note, used to build up EVEN MORE tension, resolves REALLY NEATLY to the tonic. It's A
- 6- Submediant) The sixth note is a pretty cool note, I don't know what it does specifically but I like using it as just a common note, a chill one that doesn't do much but it's always there for you, it shares many notes with the tonic so it's easy to use... in D Major it's B
- 7- Leading Tone) This is the evil one... In Every major key, you will always have a leading tone which creates a DIMINISHED CHORD. This chord sounds VERY SUSPICIOUS and you should probably avoid it if you are making a non-complicated and normal sounding song. In the D Major Key, the leading tone is C#.

CHORDS

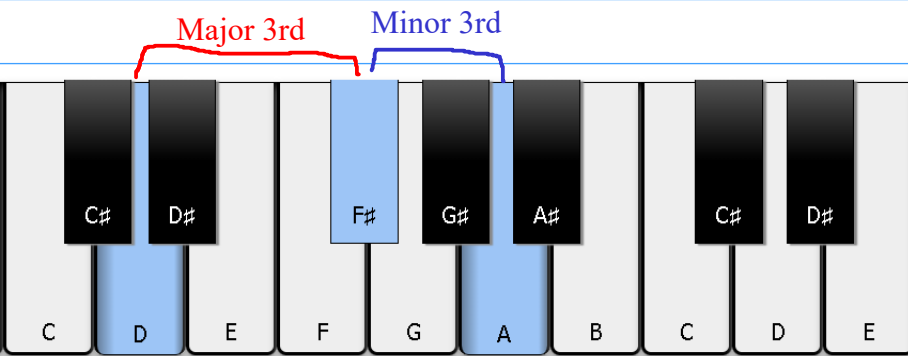
So every note in the major scale has a chord. The most common chord is composed of 3 notes, that's why it's called a **triad**

Triads can be composed of two types of intervals

Minor 3rds (3 semitones/halfsteps) and Major 3rds (4 semitones/halfsteps)

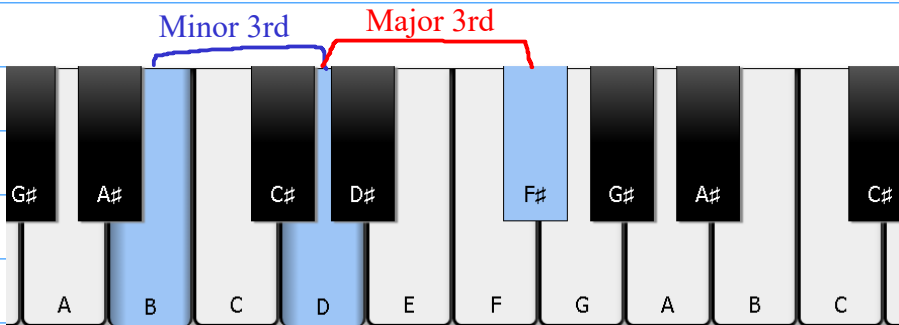
MAJOR CHORD - Chord composed of Major 3rd first and a Minor 3rd second

EXAMPLE - In the D Major Key (unsurprisingly) D has a major chord



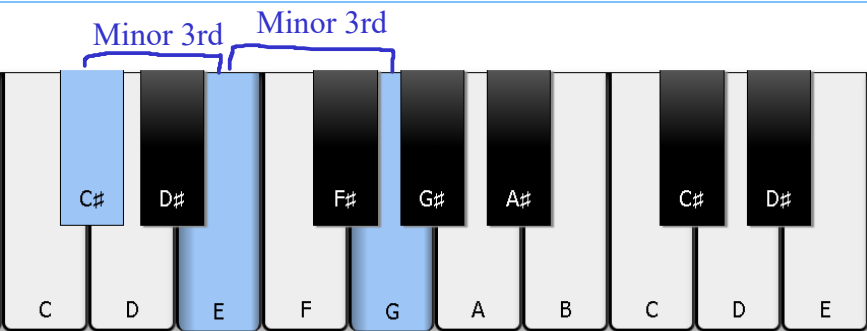
MINOR CHORD - Chord composed of Minor 3rd first and a Minor 3rd second

EXAMPLE - In D Major, the SUBMEDIANT note forms a MINOR CHORD



And since I mentioned it, in the D Major Key, the LEADING TONE is C#

This means that C# has a DIMINISHED CHORD in the D Major scale, this is a chord comprised of two Minor 3rds



WARNING, THIS CHORD IS VERY SUS

HOME WORK

If you read this, then you have officially been cursed with AWEFULL LUCK, the only way to rid yourself of your INNEVITABLE MISFORTUNE is to make a very simple song using a major key. The song must have four chords, and a melody. Enjoy your music-making, or die in despair.